



Seek Truth · Know Thyself · Serve Others

JOY ACADEMY ONLINE

Fall 2026 Letter to Students

October 5, 2026 · Faith · Seek Truth · Know Thyself · Serve Others

Dear Students,

Greetings in the Lord! As autumn brings cooler days, may you grow with joy and be filled with blessings this new semester!

It has been a month since school began. Seeing your focus, hard work, and vibrant energy in our online classrooms fills us with gratitude and joy. Keep it up—you are doing wonderfully!

1. Your Calling: To Be the Light and Salt of the World

We believe every student here is unique. Our school hopes not only that you will do well academically, but also that you will grow in character and in life. When you leave school one day, may you have both strong professional abilities and steadfast faith and good character, bringing light and blessing to the field you serve.

This school is not only here to teach you knowledge; it is here to help you discover your place in God's plan.

2. A New Beginning for Our School

- **Our WASC accreditation application has been submitted:** This summer, the school formally submitted its accreditation application to the Western Association of Schools and Colleges (WASC). This means our educational standards are becoming more structured and internationally aligned. For you, that means a stronger learning experience and a record of growth that is more widely recognized.
- **Our new website is live!** Visit joyacademy.online for course information, school news, and important announcements. Be sure to bookmark it!

3. High School Students: Opportunities to Grow Through Challenge

Our high school curriculum has grown this semester, giving you more choices:

- **Attention, 11th graders: College Counseling is offered this semester.**

This is not an ordinary college-preparation course; it is a journey of self-discovery. Together, we will ask:

- **Seek Truth:** What is true? What is right? What are the patterns? Where is the evidence?
- **Know Thyself:** Who am I? What are my strengths? Where do I still need to grow? What do I enjoy? What am I afraid of? What fills me with passion?
- **Serve Others:** What can I do for others, my family, and society? Whom am I here to serve?

These questions will help you discover a future direction that fits your calling and faith.

- **Advanced AP courses are open for enrollment:** This semester we have added **AP Microeconomics** and **AP Calculus**. All eligible high school students may enroll! These courses bring greater academic challenges, help you strengthen logical thinking and disciplined study habits, and build a solid foundation for applying to highly selective colleges.

4. Growing in Character: The Cardinal Virtues and “Seeing Each Other”

Knowledge gives you power, while character gives you direction. This semester, we will continue to deepen our character education:

- **Practicing the Cardinal Virtues, alongside faith, hope, and love:**
 - **Prudence:** Learning to discern, think, and choose;
 - **Temperance:** Practicing self-control instead of being ruled by desires and emotions;
 - **Justice:** Treating others rightly and doing what is right;
 - **Fortitude:** Persevering even when things are difficult.
- **This semester's theme — “We See Each Other”:** Our whole-school reading selection is *Wonder*, a book that is a wonderful fit for us! We hope to bridge the distance created by screens and help everyone truly learn to “see each other”:
 - **Seeing the good:** Notice your classmates' strengths and the things that make them shine;

- **Seeing needs:** Notice when a classmate needs help and support;
- **Seeing progress:** Don't compare yourself blindly with others; focus on growth: “Compared with last week, you have improved in...”;
- **Seeing reasons for gratitude:** Treasure the kindness of others and keep a grateful heart.

5. A Few Reminders for Every Student

1. **Set long-term goals:** Think about what you are working toward. Every climb brings visible growth. Without a goal, a traveler may keep going in circles; with a goal, a climber can keep crossing new heights.
2. **Pursue mastery, not perfection:** “Mastery” is more than simply “knowing how”; it means being able to do something without having to stop and think it through. Mastery is not about one-time performance, but about being consistent over time.
3. **Recognize the power of details:** Details are not trivial; they are the only path to mastery:
 - **Recitation** lets truth take root in your heart, so you don't have to look it up at the last minute;
 - **Remembering** makes the right response instinctive, without hesitation or wavering;
 - **Repetition** makes good character a habit, rather than something that requires constant restraint.
4. **Build good habits:** Get enough sleep and create a focused place to study. Pay attention to the learning process, not only the results. Nurture your curiosity and motivation to learn independently.

As Deuteronomy 8:2–3 says:

“Remember how the Lord your God led you all the way in the wilderness these forty years, to humble and test you in order to know what was in your heart, whether or not you would keep his commands. He humbled you, causing you to hunger and then feeding you with manna, which neither you nor your ancestors had known, to teach

you that we do not live on bread alone but on every word that comes from the mouth of the Lord.”

As you grow, remember God's guidance and shaping. He cares not only for your physical and academic needs, but also nurtures your soul with His Word and wisdom.

Dear students, education is a journey that takes commitment and perseverance. We are honored to walk beside you and support you along the way. This new semester, may you face challenges with courage, keep growing beyond what you thought possible, and let your life shine in Christ!

May the Lord's abundant grace fill you, and may joy go with you!

Joy Academy Online

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